

"You can run away, but that'll just make it worse!"
- Makise Kurisu

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1 NARRATIVE TEXT

1.1 Definition

A narrative text is a text that tells a story involving characters and sequence of events. Narrative texts are generally written to entertain the reader, although they may also communicate a moral lesson or message.

Common examples include:

- Fairy tales
- Legends
- Fables
- Myths
- Folk tales
- Fictional stories

1.2 Purpose

The primary purpose of a narrative text is to entertain or engage the reader through a story.

A narrative may also have a secondary purpose, such as communicating a moral lesson, explaining a cultural belief, or conveying a particular message.

For example, *The Tortoise and the Hare* entertains the reader while also communicating a lesson about perseverance and overconfidence.

1.3 Generic Structure

A narrative text commonly consists of six structural elements:

1. Orientation
2. Complication
3. Sequence of Events
4. Resolution
5. Coda

The *purpose* describes why the narrative is written, while the five elements above describe how the story is organized.

1.3.1 Orientation

The orientation introduces the basic circumstances of the story.

It commonly establishes:

- The characters
- The setting
- The time
- The initial situations

For example:

Once upon a time, a hare and a tortoise lived in a forest.

This sentence introduces the main characters and the setting.

1.3.2 Complication

The complication introduces the main problem or conflict faced by the characters.

Without a complication, there is generally no central problem for the story to resolve.

For example:

The hare challenged the tortoise to a race because he believed that he was much faster.

The challenge creates the central conflict of the story.

1.3.3 Sequence of Events

The sequence of events describe what happens as the story develops.

Events are usually presented in chronological order.

For example:

1. The race begins.
2. The hare runs far ahead.
3. The hare becomes overconfident and takes a nap.
4. The tortoise continues moving.
5. The tortoise approaches the finish line.

The sequence connects the complication to the resolution.

1.3.4 Resolution

The resolution presents the outcome of the main conflict.

For example:

The tortoise reaches the finish line before the hare and wins the race.

The resolution does not necessarily have to be happy. A narrative may have a positive, negative or unresolved outcome.

1.3.5 Coda

The coda is an optional closing section that states the lesson, moral, or message of the story.

For example:

The story teaches that consistent effort is more valuable than overconfidence.

Not every narrative contains an explicit coda. Sometimes the reader is expected to infer the message from the events and resolution.

1.4 Language Features

Narrative texts commonly use several grammatical features.

1.4.1 Simple Past Tense

The simple past tense is frequently used because narratives commonly describe events that occurred in the past.

The tortoise walked slowly toward the finish line.

The hare stopped under a tree.

Common forms include:

V2

and

was/were + complement

1.4.2 Action Verbs

Action verbs describe events and activities performed by characters.

Examples include:

ran, walked, opened, shouted, climbed, escaped, attacked

1.4.3 Temporal Connectives

Temporal connectives indicate the order or relationship between events.

Examples include:

first, then, next, after that, suddenly, finally, eventually

For example:

First, the hare ran ahead. Then, he stopped to rest. Finally, the tortoise reached the finish line.

1.4.4 Specific Participants

Narratives commonly refer to specific characters rather than general groups.

Examples include:

Belle, the Beast, the tortoise, the hare, a king, a farmer

1.4.5 Descriptive Language

Adjectives and adverbs are often used to describe characters, settings, and actions.

For example:

The frightened girl entered the dark and mysterious castle.

1.5 Narrative Structure in Practice

Consider the basic structure of *The Tortoise and the Hare*:

1. **Purpose:** To entertain the reader and communicate a moral lesson.
2. **Orientation:** A hare and a tortoise live in a forest.
3. **Complication:** The hare challenges the tortoise to a race.
4. **Sequence of Events:** The hare runs ahead, becomes overconfident, takes a nap, while the tortoise continues moving toward the finish line.
5. **Resolution:** The tortoise reaches the finish line first and wins the race.
6. **Coda:** The story teaches that perseverance is important and overconfidence can lead to failure.

1.6 How to Identify the Structure

When analyzing a narrative, the following questions can be used:

1. **Purpose:** Why was the story written?
2. **Orientation:** Who is involved, and where and when does the story begin?
3. **Complication:** What problem or conflict occurs?
4. **Sequence of Events:** What happens after the problem begins?
5. **Resolution:** How is the problem resolved?
6. **Coda:** What lesson or message does the story communicate?

1.7 Summary

A narrative can be represented as:

Orientation → Complication → Sequence of Events → Resolution → Coda

The five structural elements describe the development of the story, while the purpose explains its overall and communicative function.

The most important distinction is:

Orientation introduces the situation, complication creates the problem, sequence develops the story, resolution settles the problem, and coda gives the lesson or message.

2 REPORTED SPEECH

2.1 Definition

Reported speech is used to report what another person said without reproducing the speaker's exact words.

There are two forms of speech:

- **Direct Speech:** Reports the exact words of the speaker.
- **Indirect Speech:** Reports the meaning of what the speaker said.

Direct Speech:

Sarah said, "I am studying English."

In reported speech, quotation marks are removed, and changes may be made to pronouns, verb tenses, and expressions of time and place.

2.2 Changes in Verb Tense

When the reporting verb is in the past tense, the verb in the reported clause commonly undergoes *backshift*. The tense is moved one step backward.

Direct Speech	Reported Speech
Present Simple	Past Simple
Present Continuous	Past Continuous
Present Perfect	Past Perfect
Past Simple	Past Perfect
will	would
can	could
may	might

2.2.1 Present Simple → Past Simple

She said, "I like English."

becomes

She said that she liked English.

The general transformation is:

Present Simple → Past Simple

2.2.2 Present Continuous → Past Continuous

He said, "I am studying."

becomes

He said that he was studying.

The transformation is:

am/is/are + V-ing → was/were + V-ing

2.2.3 Present Perfect → Past Perfect

She said, "I have finished my homework."

becomes

She said that she had finished her homework.

The transformation is:

have/has + V3 → had + V3

2.2.4 Past Simple → Past Perfect

He said, "I went to Jakarta."

becomes

He said that he had gone to Jakarta.

The transformation is:

Past Simple → Past Perfect

2.2.5 will → would

He said, "I will help you."

becomes

He said that he would help me.

2.2.6 can → could

She said, "I can swim."

becomes

She said that she could swim.

2.2.7 may → might

He said, "I may come."

becomes

He said that he might come.

2.3 Changes in Pronouns

Pronouns must be changed according to their referents rather than according to a fixed substitution rule.

John said, "I am tired."

Since "I" refers to John:

John said that he was tired.

Similarly:

Lisa said to me, "You are smart."

becomes

Lisa told me that I was smart.

The correct pronoun therefore depends on who is speaking and who is being addressed.

2.4 Changes in Time and Place Expressions

Expressions referring to time and place may change when the statement is reported from a different context.

Direct	Reported
today	that day
tomorrow	the next day / the following day
yesterday	the day before / the previous day
now	then
tonight	that night
this	that
these	those
here	there
ago	before

For example:

She said, "I will finish it tomorrow."

becomes

She said that she would finish it the next day.

2.5 Say and Tell

The verbs *say* and *tell* have different grammatical patterns.

Say:

He said that he was tired.

Tell:

He told me that he was tired.

The basic patterns are:

say + something

tell + person + something

Therefore:

He said that he was tired.

and

He told me that he was tired.

are correct, while “He told that he was tired” is incorrect.

2.6 Reported Statements

The basic structure is:

Subject + said/told + (that) + reported clause

For example:

Direct: John said, “I am busy.”

Reported: John said that he was busy.

The conjunction *that* may be omitted:

John said that he was busy.

John said he was busy.

Both forms are grammatically acceptable.

2.7 Reported Questions

Reported questions use statement word order rather than normal question word order.

2.7.1 Yes/No Questions

For questions that require a “yes” or “no” answer, use *if* or *whether*.

Direct: He asked, “Are you tired?”

Reported: He asked me if I was tired.

The structure is:

Subject + asked + object + if/whether + statement

The auxiliary *do* is not retained in the reported question.

Direct: “Do you like coffee?”

Reported: She asked me whether I liked coffee.

2.7.2 WH-Questions

For questions beginning with *what*, *where*, *when*, *why*, *who*, *how*, or *which*, the question word is retained.

Direct: She asked, “Where do you live?”

Reported: She asked me where I lived.

Direct: He asked, “Why did you leave?”

Reported: He asked me why I had left.

The essential rule is:

Reported question = question word + statement word order

Thus:

She asked me where I lived.

is correct, while:

She asked me where did I live.

is incorrect.

2.8 Reported Commands and Requests

Commands are commonly reported using:

tell + person + to + V1

For example:

Direct: The teacher said, "Open your book."

Reported: The teacher told us to open our books.

Negative commands use:

tell + person + not to + V1

For example:

Direct: Dad said, "Don't touch that."

Reported: Dad told me not to touch that.

Requests commonly use:

ask + person + to + V1

For example:

Direct: She said, "Please help me."

Reported: She asked me to help her.

2.9 When Backshift Is Not Necessary

Backshift is common when the reporting verb is in the past, but it is not always mandatory. If the reported statement describes a fact that remains true, the original tense may be retained.

Direct: Sarah said, "The Earth is round."
Reported: Sarah said that the Earth is round.

The present tense is appropriate because the statement remains true.

Similarly:

He says, "I am tired."

becomes:

He says that he is tired.

When the reporting verb is in the present tense, backshift is generally unnecessary.

2.10 A Systematic Transformation Procedure

A direct sentence can be converted into reported speech by following these steps:

1. Identify the reporting verb.
2. Determine whether the original sentence is a statement, question, command, or request.
3. Identify the referents of all pronouns.
4. Apply the appropriate tense changes when backshift is required.
5. Change relevant expressions of time and place.
6. For questions, use statement word order.
7. Check that the final sentence preserves the meaning of the original.

2.11 Complete Example

Consider:

David said to Maria, "I will finish this project tomorrow because I am very busy today."

The transformation can be performed as follows:

1. "said to Maria" can become "told Maria".
2. "I" refers to David, so it becomes "he".

3. "will finish" becomes "would finish".
4. "this" becomes "that".
5. "tomorrow" becomes "the next day".
6. "am" becomes "was".
7. "today" becomes "that day".

The resulting sentence is:

David told Maria that he would finish that project the next day because he was very busy that day.

2.12 Summary

The principal transformations in reported speech are:

Direct	Reported
am/is/are	was/were
V1	V2
am/is/are + V-ing	was/were + V-ing
have/has + V3	had + V3
V2	had + V3
will	would
can	could
may	might

The fundamental structures are:

Statement: said/told + (that) + statement

Yes/No question: asked + if/whether + statement

WH-question: asked + WH-word + statement

Command/request: told/asked + object + to + V1

The transformation should not be treated as a mechanical substitution of words. Pronouns, tense, time, and place must be changed according to the relationship between the original statement and the context in which it is reported.